Table 1. December 2003 CSF Guidance for Embassies, Combatant Commanders, and the Comptroller.

Office responsibiliy	Guidance
Defense personnel (such as ODRP) at embassies assist host country military personnel in formulating their claims for reimbursement before forwarding the claims to their combatant commander.	• CSF reimburses countries that have incurred incremental costs (i.e., above and beyond normal levels) to provide logistical and military support to U.S. military operations in connection with U.S. operations in Iraq, Afghanistan, and elsewhere in the global war on terrorism. • Examples of reimbursable costs: transport of forces, sustainment of forces, increased use of equipment or vehicles. • Requests for reimbursement must contain quantifiable information that clearly indicates incremental nature of support, such as total personnel fed, number and types of vehicles repaired, total fuel consumed, total number of flight sorties.
Combatant commanders (such as CENTCOM) must submit documentation to the Comptroller that sufficiently supports the country's reimbursement request.	• Identification of who requested the service, for what period of time (i.e., a one-time reimbursement requirement versus a recurring requirement), and the initial estimate of the cost of the support or service. • Validation that the support or service was provided, and confirmation that the costs incurred were incremental (i.e., that the costs were based on the U.S. requirement and would not otherwise have been incurred by the country requesting reimbursement). • A narrative description of the types of costs incurred and a description of how the costs for each were computed. • Copies of invoices for support provided, or in the absence of invoices, documentation supporting how the costs were derived for each category of cost, and their basis of measurement.
Comptroller receives the package from CENTCOM and evaluates the reasonableness of the reimbursement request.	• Comparison, at a macro level, of claimed costs to the U.S. cost to provide the same support. • Evaluation of the reasonableness of the individual categories for which reimbursement is requested. • Comparison of representative U.S. costs for a subset of items (where similar comparisons can be made). • Assessment that the claimed costs are consistent with previous reimbursement requests.

Source: Defense.

In response, the Comptroller published guidance in December 2003 to clarify the roles and responsibilities of CENTCOM and other regional combatant commanders and of the Comptroller in the CSF oversight process. The 2003 guidance notes that Congress provided the Secretary of Defense with the authority to determine how much to reimburse partner countries, and how much documentation was required to adequately account for the support provided. However, the guidance also stated that CENTCOM and the Comptroller are to obtain sufficient documentation to validate that Pakistani military support had been provided and that costs were incurred, reasonable, and appropriate under the CSF program. Table 1 summarizes the review criteria in the December 2003 Comptroller guidance. We address the implementation of these and other criteria in greater detail later in this report.

Under the December 2003 guidance and oversight process, Pakistan would first submit its claim for reimbursement to ODRP at the U.S. Embassy in Islamabad. According to Comptroller guidance, ODRP would assist the Pakistani military in formulating the reimbursement claim before sending the claim to CENTCOM in Tampa, Florida. CENTCOM

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